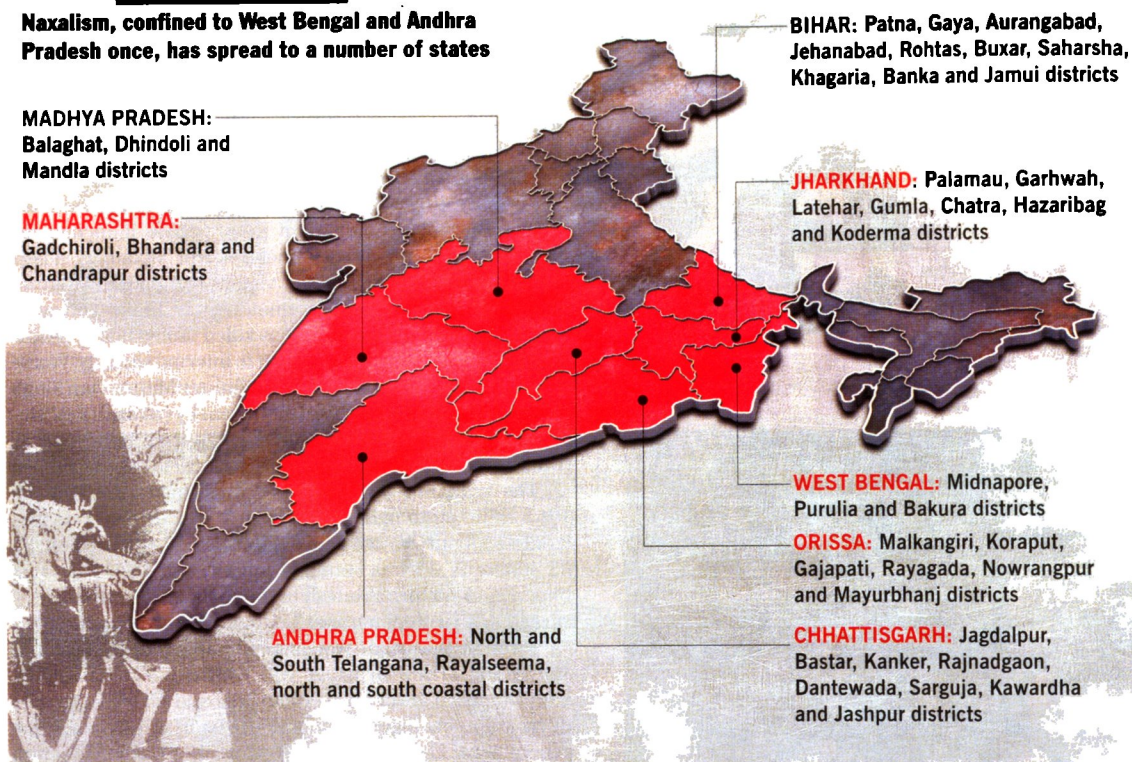


The **RISING**

Naxalism, confined to West Bengal and Andhra Pradesh once, has spread to a number of states

MADHYA PRADESH: Balaghat, Bhandara and Mandla districts

MAHARASHTRA: Gadchiroli, Bhandara and Chandrapur districts



MULTI-PRONGED ATTACK

■ Of the total **12,476** police stations in the country, Maoist violence was reported from **395** in 11 states in 2006.

■ Till June 2007, there were **842** incidents of Maoist violence as against **827** during the corresponding period in 2006. Again, till June 2007, **138** police personnel had been killed by the Maoists as compared to **92** in 2006.

■ Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand together accounted for **67.46** per cent of the total incidents and **75.98** per cent of the total number of casualties in 2007.

Source: The Union Home Ministry

out the country and wage a mass movement against the neo-liberal policies of globalisation, liberalisation and privatisation pursued by the reactionary ruling classes under the dictates of imperialism." They also decided to expand the armed struggle from "guerrilla war" to "urban and mobile warfare" focusing on industrial areas. An "annual report" of the 'Central Military Commission' of the CPI(Maoist), seized by security forces, lists several upcoming projects in Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand and Andhra Pradesh like the projects of Tata, Essar and Jindal groups in Chhattisgarh, the Polvaram irrigation project in Andhra Pradesh as targets.

The militants' misplaced ideology finds strength from

the very concerns the Government is trying to grapple with—exploitation, low wages, unemployment and an underdeveloped farm sector. The need for economic development in the areas in which they operate is fodder for the Naxalites' campaign. They fire the imagination of sceptical villagers with the thought that any development will ultimately be detrimental to them. They support the villagers' refusal to give up their land for these projects and are responsible for their resistance to Special Economic Zones and other big ticket investments.

Many states are resorting to local mobilisation drives like Salwa Judum and Nagrik Suraksha Samiti—ways of pri-